

Naija

Slangs

Dictionary API

The definitive open-source API for Nigerian slang, pidgin expressions & street lingo.

5,000+

Slang Words

50+

Contributors

100K+

API Calls/Mo

MIT

License

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§ SECTION 01

The Problem & Vision

Why NaijaSlangs needs to exist

NO STRUCTURED API

Developers building Naija-focused apps hardcode slang manually — no reliable, machine-readable source exists.

SUBTITLING FAILURE

Nollywood & Afrobeats subtitling tools break on pidgin and street lingo, failing millions of global viewers.

NLP DATA GAP

AI/ML models trained on Nigerian social media lack labelled data, causing poor sentiment analysis for African languages.

CULTURAL BARRIER

Tourists, foreigners, and diaspora have no reliable lookup tool for Nigerian culture, slang & identity.



The Vision

A free, community-driven API with a contributor portal, open dataset on GitHub, and full developer tooling — becoming the definitive linguistic infrastructure for Nigerian digital culture. Built with FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis & Elasticsearch.

YEAR 1 TARGETS

5,000+

Words

500+

API Keys

1,000+

GitHub Stars

100K+

Monthly Calls

50+

Contributors



§ SECTION 02

Dataset Sources

Where to get your slang data

The content layer is the hardest part. Here are your best real sources — tiered by quality and reliability.

TIER 1 – COMMUNITY GOLD

Twitter / X API v2

twitter.com/developer

Scrape trending Nigerian slang in real-time using hashtags like #Naija, #PidginEnglish, #LagosStreet. Use academic access for bulk historical data.

Nairaland.com

nairaland.com

Largest Nigerian forum with millions of posts. Rich pidgin and slang usage in natural context. Scrape threads in /entertainment, /romance, /jokes.

Urban Dictionary (Nigeria tag)

urbandictionary.com

Filter entries tagged Nigeria, Pidgin, Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa. Use their API. Quality varies — needs moderation layer.

TIER 2 – ACADEMIC & STRUCTURED

AfriSenti Dataset

github.com/hausanlp/AfriSenti

Multilingual sentiment dataset covering Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo with annotated tweets. MIT Licensed. Ready-to-use JSON.

MENYO-20k / Masakhane

github.com/masakhane-io

Open-source African NLP datasets. Yoruba/Igbo/Hausa translations, great for etymology and cross-referencing definitions.

Wiktionary (Yoruba/Igbo/Hausa)

wiktionary.org

Structured lexical data with etymology, phonetics. Download full dump in XML — filter for Nigerian languages. Free, CC-BY-SA.

TIER 3 – MANUAL & COMMUNITY

Manual Contributor Portal

[your own site](#)

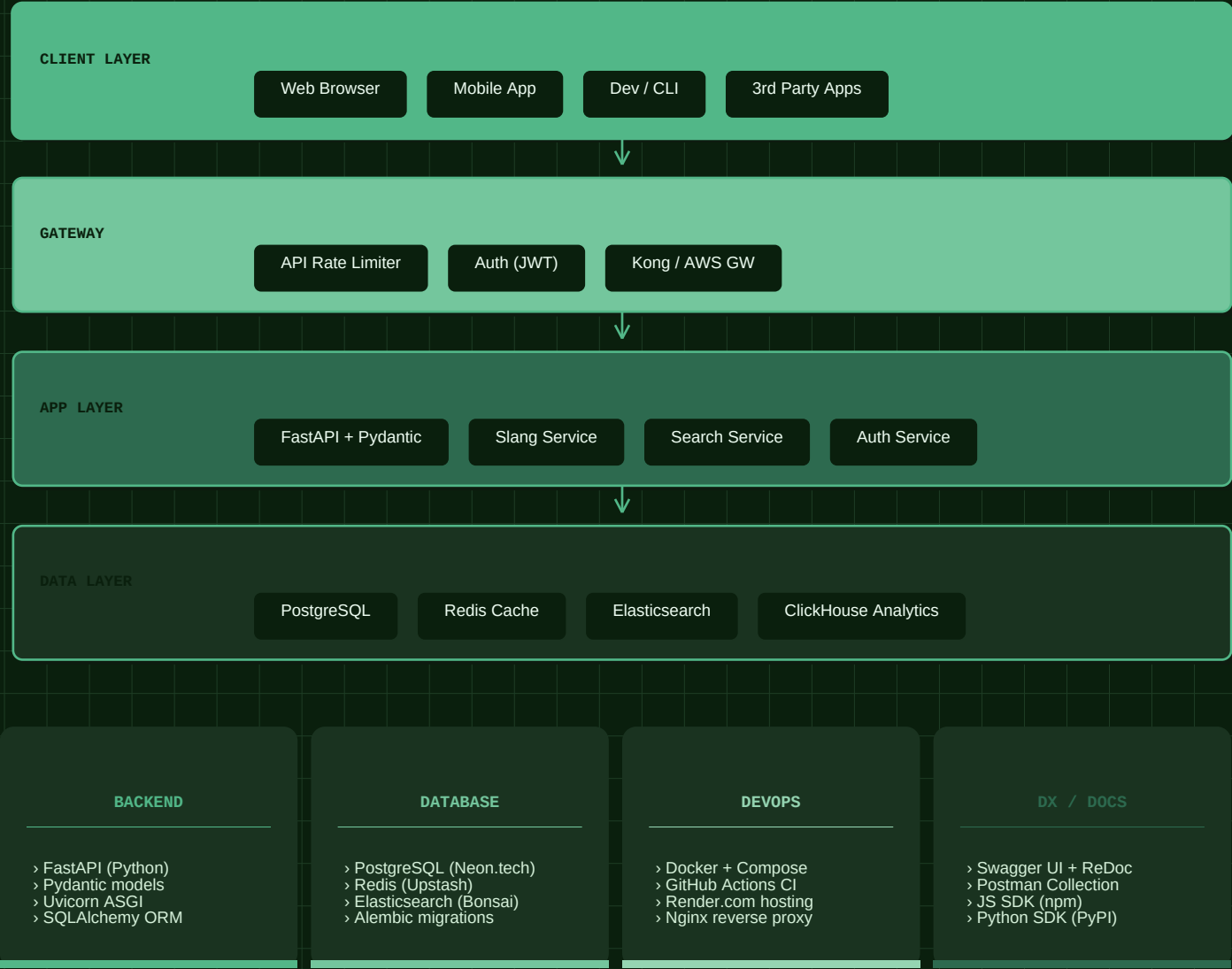
Build a web form for community submissions. Each word gets definition, example sentence, region tag, language group. Moderate before merge.



§ SECTION 03

Tech Stack

Architecture & tools — chosen for solo/small team builds





§ SECTION 04

Build Roadmap

Phase-by-phase execution plan

01

FOUNDATION

Weeks 1-6

- PostgreSQL schema design (slangs, categories, regions, contributors)
- Seed 500 slang words manually with definitions, examples, phonetics
- FastAPI project structure + Docker Compose (app + postgres + redis + ES)

02

CORE API

Weeks 5-10

- CRUD endpoints: GET/POST/PUT/DELETE /slangs with pagination & filtering
- API key auth (JWT) + rate limiting (free: 100 req/hr, open: unlimited)
- Input validation with Pydantic + automated test suite (80%+ coverage)

03

SEARCH & DX

Weeks 9-14

- Elasticsearch: full-text fuzzy search with typo tolerance + phonetics
- Swagger UI + ReDoc auto-generated docs + live API playground (Next.js)
- JavaScript SDK (npm: naijaslangs-js) + Python SDK (PyPI: naijaslangs-py)

04

OPEN SOURCE LAUNCH

Weeks 13-18

- Public GitHub launch: detailed README, badges, demo GIFs
- Contributor portal: web form to submit new slang words + moderation queue
- Launch on Product Hunt, Dev.to, Hashnode, Twitter/X with launch thread

05

GROWTH & SCALE

Month 5-12

- GraphQL endpoint, mobile SDKs (React Native + Flutter)
- Nigerian university partnerships (UniLag, UNIABUJA) for student contributions
- Bulk dataset exports for NLP/AI researchers (CSV, JSON, JSONL)



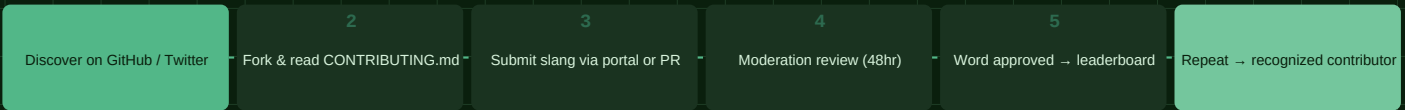
§ SECTION 05

Community & Contribution

Building the people layer

Open source lives or dies by its community. Here's how to build one that sustains the project.

CONTRIBUTOR JOURNEY



CONTRIBUTOR INCENTIVES

 **Public Leaderboard**

Top contributors listed on naijaslangs.dev with GitHub handles and word count. Permanent

 **Contributor Badge**

GitHub profile badge and README credit for approved contributors. Carries OSS credibility.

 **Slang of the Week**

Top contributor's word featured weekly on Twitter/X tagging their handle. Organic social exposure.

 **University Credits**

Partner with CS departments — student contributions count toward open source coursework

 **API Access**

Top contributors get elevated rate limits and early access to new endpoints and dataset exports.

 **Co-author Credits**

Significant contributors credited co-authors in academic dataset papers and publications.

KEY DATABASE TABLES

slangs id, word, slug, definition, examples (JSONB), phonetic, audio_url...	contributors id, github_handle, email, total_approved, joined_at
submissions id, word, definition, status, contributor_id, reviewed_at	regions id, name, code – Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano, etc.



§ SECTION 06

Promotion Strategy

Reaching developers & Nigerian culture globally

A free, open-source project lives by visibility. Here's a layered promotional strategy.

LAUNCH WAVE TIMELINE

WAVE 1

Month 1-2

Soft Launch

- GitHub repo public
- Dev.to article
- Twitter thread

WAVE 2

Month 3-4

Community Push

- Product Hunt launch
- DevCareers Slack
- #NaijaSlangChallenge

WAVE 3

Month 5-6

Media Reach

- Techpoint Africa pitch
- YouTube walkthrough
- Reddit r/programming

WAVE 4

Month 7-12

Scale & Partner

- University partnerships
- API Hackathon
- State of Naija report

PROMOTION CHANNELS & EXPECTED REACH

Twitter / X	Launch thread with demo GIF + live API playground link	5K-20K impressions
Dev.to / Hashnode	Full architecture write-up — how I built a Nigerian Slang AP	3K-10K reads
Product Hunt	Full product launch with video demo on launch day	500-2K upvotes
GitHub Stars	Outreach to Nigerian dev Discord / Telegram groups	500-1.5K stars
DevCareers Slack	Share in #projects — largest Nigerian dev community	300-800 signups
Techpoint Africa	Pitch to podcast as African OSS infrastructure story	5K-20K listeners
Reddit	r/programming, r/webdev, r/Nigeria — live demo post	500-3K views
YouTube	5-min "Building a Public API in Python" walkthrough	1K-5K views

COMMUNITY GROWTH INITIATIVES

Slang of the Week

Tweet a new slang word weekly — build to 1K+ followers organically

#NaijaSlangChallenge

Twitter challenge: tweet your fav slang + tag @NaijaSlangsAPI

API Hackathon

Sponsor a mini hackathon: "Build something with NaijaSlangs API"

Uni Partnerships

Partner with UniLag, UNIABUJA CS depts for student contributions



Ship It.

The market is waiting.

Nigeria's digital culture deserves world-class linguistic infrastructure.

You're the one to build it.

`naijaslangs.dev`

`github.com/icedmist/naijaslangs-api`

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